

PUNJAB ORIGIN

Butter Naan

Soft Tandoor Bread, Double-Basted
The Richest Naan on the Menu

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

LICENSE & COPYRIGHT NOTICE

Butter Naan

Sold via: Gumroad
Publisher: DhanioDigital (dhaniodigital.gumroad.com)

PERSONAL USE LICENSE

This digital cookbook is licensed for personal, non-commercial use only.
You may print one (1) copy for your own kitchen use.

YOU MAY NOT:

- Share, resell, or redistribute this file in any form
- Upload to any website, cloud service, or file-sharing platform
- Remove or obscure any watermarks, copyright notices, or branding
- Use recipes for commercial food service without written permission

Violation of this license may result in legal action.

© 2024 DhanioDigital. All rights reserved.
Contact: support@dhaniodigital.com

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Butter Naan

AUTHOR

Sweta Verma

PUBLISHER

DhanioDigital

COPYRIGHT

© 2026 Sweta Verma. All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced or distributed without written permission from the publisher.

DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Dhaba Trick That Became a Menu Staple

Butter naan grew directly out of Punjab's roadside dhaba culture, where cooks discovered that a generous, double baste of butter — once straight off the tandoor and often again just before serving — transformed a good naan into something unforgettable. It's a simple idea, but one that turned an everyday bread into the single most-ordered item on countless North Indian restaurant menus.

Unlike plain naan, which was historically eaten as a functional bread to scoop up curry, butter naan positioned itself as something closer to an indulgence — richer, glossier, and often eaten on its own before the curry even arrives at the table. It's the version most travelers to India first fall in love with, and the version most commonly requested by name at Indian restaurants worldwide.

Some dhabas take the technique even further, brushing the dough with butter before it goes into the tandoor as well as after, so the butter both bastes and lightly fries the surface as it cooks — a detail this recipe borrows for extra richness.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Dhaba Trick That Became a Menu Staple, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

A dhaba and restaurant favorite across Punjab and Delhi, now one of the most internationally recognized North Indian breads. Frequently the first thing ordered at Indian restaurants, often eaten on its own before the main curry arrives. A generous butter baste is considered a mark of a good tandoor cook — thin or sparing butter is seen as a shortcut.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

20m	1.5h	20m	6
ACTIVE PREP	DOUGH RISE	COOK TIME	SERVINGS (6 NAANS)

Med
DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Large mixing bowl
- Rolling pin
- Heavy cast-iron tava, skillet, or a pizza stone/steel in the oven
- Two basting brushes — one for each butter application
- Tongs for direct-flame finishing

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Dough can be refrigerated after its first rise for up to a day. Cooked butter naan is best fresh, as the butter's richness is most noticeable warm, but leftovers keep at room temperature for a few hours or refrigerated for 2 days — reheat on a hot tava and re-baste with fresh butter before serving.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dough

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
All-purpose flour (maida)	3 cups	375 g	3 katori
Instant yeast	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Sugar	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Plain yogurt	3 tbsp	45 g	3 chammach
Milk, lukewarm	½ cup	120 ml	½ katori
Water, lukewarm	¼ cup	60 ml	¼ katori
Butter, softened (in the dough)	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Salt	1 tsp	6 g	to taste

For the double butter baste

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Unsalted butter, melted	4 tbsp	60 g	4 chammach
Salted butter, for the finishing baste	2 tbsp	30 g	2 chammach

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Salted or unsalted butter both work — salted butter gives a slightly savory edge that many dhabas prefer for the final baste. Ghee can replace butter for a nuttier, more traditional flavor, though butter naan specifically calls for real butter's dairy richness. If you're dairy-sensitive, a good plant-based butter substitute works reasonably well for basting, though the dough itself already contains yogurt.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Dough

01 ACTIVATE THE YEAST

Combine the warm milk, sugar, and yeast in a small bowl and let sit 8–10 minutes until foamy.

02 MIX AND KNEAD

Combine flour and salt in a large bowl. Add the yeast mixture, yogurt, softened butter, and warm water, mixing to a shaggy dough, then knead 8–10 minutes until smooth and soft.

03 LET IT RISE

Place in an oiled bowl, cover, and let rise in a warm spot for 1–1.5 hours until doubled.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Dough, continued



COOKING CHECKPOINT

The dough is ready when doubled in size and a gentle finger poke springs back slowly, leaving a soft indent.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Shaping, Cooking & The Double Baste

04 DIVIDE AND SHAPE

Punch down the dough, divide into 6 balls, and roll or hand-stretch each into an oval about ¼ inch / 6 mm thick.

05 BRUSH BEFORE COOKING

Lightly brush the top surface of the rolled dough with a little of the melted unsalted butter before it goes onto the pan — this is the dhaba trick that lightly fries the surface as it cooks.

06 COOK ON A HOT TAVA

Wet the underside of the naan with water and press onto a very hot tava. Cook until bubbles form and the base is golden, 1–2 minutes, then flip and finish the second side, or char briefly over an open flame with tongs.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Shaping, Cooking & The Double Baste, continued



07 THE FINAL BASTE

The moment each naan comes off the heat, brush generously with the salted butter — don't be shy, this is what defines the dish. Stack under a cloth to keep warm and soft.

Chef tip. baste while the naan is still steaming hot — the butter melts into every air pocket rather than sitting on the surface.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Shaping, Cooking & The Double Baste, continued

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Basting with cold or barely-melted butter is a common shortcut that leaves naan greasy rather than glossy. Always use fully melted, warm butter for the best absorption.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served immediately, still glistening, often eaten on its own before the curry course arrives.
- A dhaba favorite alongside dal makhani and paneer butter masala.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Restaurant Presentation

- Served whole or cut into wedges in a warm bread basket, butter sheen visible.

Family Style

- A shared basket at the table, re-brushed with a little extra butter right before serving for maximum shine.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Richness Right

- Two separate butter applications — before and after cooking — gives noticeably more flavor than one heavy baste.
- Salted butter for the final baste rounds out the flavor better than unsalted.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Dough can rise overnight in the refrigerator for a deeper flavor — bring to room temperature before shaping.
- Melt your basting butter fresh right before cooking rather than in advance, so it's warm and fluid when needed.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some dhabas whip a small amount of cream into the finishing butter for an extra-glossy, slightly thicker baste — try it for a special-occasion version.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

320 kcal	7 g	42 g	13 g	1.5 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with fat used and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Garlic Butter Naan	add minced garlic to the finishing butter baste.
Herb Butter Naan	mix chopped coriander or mint into the melted butter.
Chili Butter Naan	a pinch of red chili flakes stirred into the baste for heat.
Cheese Butter Naan	a modern addition, stuffed with shredded cheese before cooking.

Can I use ghee instead of butter?

Yes, though the flavor shifts from rich and dairy-forward to nuttier and more traditional — both are authentic choices depending on region.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

How do I keep the naan soft after basting?

Stack basted naan in a cloth-lined basket or wrap in a clean kitchen towel — the trapped steam keeps them soft.

Is butter naan very different to make from plain naan?

The dough and cooking method are identical — the only difference is the butter application before and after cooking.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Tandoor	a traditional clay oven capable of very high, dry heat.
Dhaba	a roadside eatery in North India, often credited with popularizing butter naan.
Maida	refined white flour, the traditional base for naan dough.
Makhan	Hindi for butter, particularly fresh, unsalted white butter.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Butter Naan

20m ACTIVE PREP	**1.5h** DOUGH RISE
20m COOK TIME	**6** SERVINGS (6 NAANS)
Med DIFFICULTY	

DOUGH

All-purpose flour	375 g
Instant yeast	3 g
Sugar	4 g
Plain yogurt	45 g
Milk	120 ml
Water	60 ml
Butter	15 g
Salt	6 g

DOUBLE BUTTER BASTE

Unsalted butter	60 g
Salted butter	30 g

METHOD

01 **Activate the yeast.** Combine the warm milk, sugar, and yeast in a small bowl and let sit 8–10 minutes until foamy.

02 **Mix and knead.** Combine flour and salt in a large bowl.

03 **Let it rise.** Place in an oiled bowl, cover, and let rise in a warm spot for 1–1.5 hours until doubled.

04 **Divide and shape.** Punch down the dough, divide into 6 balls, and roll or hand-stretch each into an oval about ¼ inch / 6 mm thick.

05 **Brush before cooking.** Lightly brush the top surface of the rolled dough with a little of the melted unsalted butter before it goes onto the pan — this is the dhaba trick that lightly fries the surface as it cooks.

06 **Cook on a hot tava.** Wet the underside of the naan with water and press onto a very hot tava.

07 **The final baste.** The moment each naan comes off the heat, brush generously with the salted butter — don't be shy, this is what defines the dish.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐	All-purpose flour	375 g	
☐	Sugar	4 g	
☐	Milk	120 ml	
☐	Salt	6 g	
☐	Salted butter	30 g	
☐	Instant yeast	3 g	
☐	Plain yogurt	45 g	
☐	Butter	15 g	
☐	Unsalted butter	60 g	

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com